

Problem 4

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Problem 1 Let $f(x) = \frac{\ln(x)}{x-2}$.

(a) Evaluate the limit.

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow 2^-} \frac{\ln(x)}{x-2}$$

Explanation. This limit is of the form $\frac{\#}{0}$, the numerator positive, and the denominator is negative. Therefore, $\lim_{x \rightarrow 2^-} \frac{\ln x}{x-2} = -\infty$.

(b) Find the vertical asymptotes of f . **EXPLAIN** and justify your answer.

Explanation. $x = 2$ is a vertical asymptote of f since $\lim_{x \rightarrow 2^-} \frac{\ln x}{x-2} = -\infty$ calculated in part (a).

On the other hand, we know that

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow 0^+} \ln(x) = -\infty.$$

So, it follows that

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow 0^+} \frac{\ln(x)}{x-2} = \infty,$$

since the limit is of the form $\frac{\infty}{\#}$, the numerator negative, and the denominator negative. That means $x = 0$ is a vertical asymptote of f since

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow 0^+} \frac{\ln x}{x-2} = \infty$$